Right-Size Voice

Teacher Guide · Topic 11 of 12 · Value: Respectful





At a glance	
Goal	Students match their voice to the place with the school's voice levels: 0 when someone is talking to the group and in the hallway, 1 for partner share and reading to myself, 2 for cafeteria table talk, 3 for presenting and gym team games, 4 outside at recess. Before talking: look around, ask "Who needs to hear me?", turn my dial, and check it again.
Time	15 minutes in Morning Meeting, in place of the general lesson. Centers run during the week.
When	Teach after Topic 10, School Words. Teach it on a calm day, early in a week with lunch, gym, and lots of transitions.
In the bundle	Student deck (7 slides, press N for notes) · Poster (letter and 11×17) · Center kit (sort, sequence, act it out, desk strips, coloring) · Mini book · Family half-sheet
Words we use	"Look around. Who needs to hear me? Turn my dial." · "Let's take it back to two!" · 0 Lips closed · 1 Whisper · 2 Table talk · 3 Whole room · 4 Outside

Before you teach

- Post the voice chart at child height near the door, the meeting area, and the cafeteria line-up spot.
- Practice the dial gesture: pinch your fingers and twist, like turning a radio knob.
- Plan the places for the "Turn Your Dial" game on slide 5, using your own room, hallway, cafeteria, and gym.
- Share the voice chart and the dial gesture with the lunch, gym, and recess staff so the signal is the same everywhere.
- Tape a desk strip (the voice chart) at the table of any student who calls out or gets loud at lunch.
- Seat students who are sensitive to loud sounds away from the speaker for the song.

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The lesson, slide by slide

The same script is in the deck's presenter notes. Press N while presenting.

Slide	Say and do	Look for	Engagement move
1 · Title & Promise (R2)	Say good morning three ways: whisper, booming, just right. "Which one fit our circle?" Say together: "Right-size voice!"	Students repeat the line at a 2.	Equity stick: "Show me a 2 voice."
2 · Get Calm First (R1)	Do it with them. "Smell the flower. Blow out the candle. Long and slow. Three times."	Exhale longer than inhale; shoulders drop.	LiveSchool point: "You breathed slow three times."
3 · Lee and Tee's Day (R2, R3)	Point to each picture and hold up the number: 0 someone is talking, 0 hallway, 1 partner and reading, 2 lunch table, 3 presenting and gym, 4 recess. For each, ask "Who needs to hear me?" Teach the dial gesture. Class says: "Look around. Who needs to hear me? Turn my dial."	Students show each number and copy the dial.	Equity stick: "Who needs to hear you at lunch?"
4 · Turn and Talk (R3, R4)	"The lunch table got louder and louder. What can Lee say? Let's take it back to ___." 30 seconds, then two shares and say it together.	Each pair names a number; guide toward 2.	Equity stick: two shares.
5 · Turn Your Dial (R3, R4, R5)	Name a place; students ask who needs to hear, show the number, turn the dial, and say "Hello, friend" at that size. Then a student presents "This is my family" at a 3; the back row says if they could hear.	Fingers match the place; dial before talking; a 3 the back row can hear.	LiveSchool point for the student model.
6 · My Promise Today (R2, R5)	Hand on heart. "Say it with me: I use the right voice for the place." Then: "Point to one thing you do before you talk."	Every student says the promise and points to one picture.	Equity stick: three names. Pointing counts.
7 · How We Leave (R1, R4, R5)	"Who needs to hear us in the hallway? Nobody. Turn your dial to 0. Stand tall. Voice at 0. Walk. Ready to learn." Do not time this at K–2.	Tall, calm bodies; voices at 0 while moving.	LiveSchool point for a student who turns the dial on their own.

Practice bridges for slide 5

Students model, not the teacher. The teacher narrates and asks the class what they saw.

If the model is...	Say
Excellent	"Show us again. Everyone, watch the dial."
Partly right	"Right number! Now check it: could the back row hear? Turn it up and try again."
Silly	"Thank you. Let's hear it right-size." Call a new student. No commentary.

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Centers

Print one kit per group. Laminate the mats and cards so they last. Students work in groups of 2 to 4.

Center	Set up	Read to students	Done looks like
Sort It	Sort mat (landscape page) and 8 cut picture cards.	"Look at each picture. Is this voice the right size for the place? Put it on the side where it goes."	4 cards on Right-size voice, 4 on Not right-size. Accept any sort a student can explain.
Put It in Order	Sequencing mat and 4 cut cards.	"Put Lee and Tee's day in order: first, next, then, last. Say the voice number for each one."	Students order the day and name each number: morning meeting 0, partner reading 1, lunch 2, recess 4.
Act It Out	4 role-play cards in a stack.	"Pick a card. Ask, who needs to hear me? Show the number, turn your dial, and say it."	Each student shows the right number and says the line at that size.
Our Voice Levels	Desk strips, one per student.	"Point to each number and say the word at that size."	Each student says all five at the right size.
Color	Coloring page and crayons.	"Color Lee and Tee at lunch. Then tell a friend about your day at a 2."	A colored page and one sentence at a 2.

Answer keys

- **Sort, Right-size:** Lee and Tee partner reading at 1 · The lunch table at 2 · Tee presenting at 3 · Lee and Tee at recess at 4.
- **Sort, Not right-size:** Kiara calls out while the teacher talks · Diego yells in the hallway · Malik mumbles when presenting · Kiara and Diego get too loud at lunch.
- **Put It in Order:** 1 Morning meeting, voice 0 · 2 Partner reading, voice 1 · 3 Lunch table, voice 2 · 4 Recess, voice 4.

The mini book (one child, Tier 2)

- For a child who calls out, gets loud at lunch, or speaks too softly to be heard. Read it one-on-one at a calm time, before the hardest part of the day.
- Read it every day for a week. Practice the dial gesture and each number as you read.
- Never read it as a consequence or right after an incident.
- On the back, the child colors a star each day they use a right-size voice. Celebrate every star.

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When a student's voice is not right-size

Follows the Responsive Behavior Plan: the adult response is the intervention. Fewer words as escalation rises.

1. **Use the signal, not your voice.** Hold up the number or show the dial. Do not raise your voice to lower theirs.
2. **Ask the question.** "Who needs to hear you?" is usually enough. Let the student turn the dial.
3. **Walk over.** Model it: walk to the student and speak at a 1 or 2. Calling across the room teaches calling across the room.
4. **Too soft counts too.** For a quiet presenter, say, "The back row needs to hear you. Turn your dial to 3." Celebrate the try.
5. **Check for more.** If a big voice comes with anger, use Topic 10, School Words, or a calm-corner break first.

Next in the toolkit: Topic 12, I Stay With My Class.

Family connection

- Send the family half-sheet home the day you teach. It is in English, Spanish, and Haitian Creole.

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